

Anatomy of Flowering Plants

Annual Board Examination High-Yield Blueprint & Quick Revision Guide

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1. BLUEPRINT & EXAM PATTERN (4 MARKS TOTAL)

Question Combinations (4 Marks)

- **Pattern A (3M + 1M):** One 3-mark conceptual/difference question + One 1-mark objective/VSA definition.
- **Pattern B (2M + 2M):** Two 2-mark short reasoning or definition questions.
- **Pattern C (2M + 1M + 1M):** One 2-mark question + Two 1-mark objective questions / MCQs.

Core High-Probability Focus Areas

- **Dicot vs. Monocot Root (3 differences)**
- **Dicot vs. Monocot Stem (3 differences)**
- **Stomatal Apparatus & Bulliform Cells**
- **Radial vs. Conjoint / Open vs. Closed Bundles**
- **Casparian Strips, Stele & Conjunctive Tissue**

2. HIGH-YIELD 3-MARK QUESTIONS

3 MARKS 1. Differentiate between Dicot Root and Monocot Root

Give three important anatomical differences:

- **Xylem Bundles:** 2 to 4 patches (Diarch to Tetrarch) in Dicot root vs. Polyarch (more than 6 patches) in Monocot root.
- **Pith:** Small or inconspicuous in Dicot root vs. Large and well-developed in Monocot root.
- **Secondary Growth:** Present in Dicot root (cambium ring develops) vs. Completely absent in Monocot root.

3 MARKS 2. Differentiate between Dicot Stem and Monocot Stem

- **Vascular Bundles:** Arranged in a ring, open (cambium present) in Dicot stem vs. Scattered throughout ground tissue, closed (cambium absent) in Monocot stem.
- **Hypodermis:** Collenchymatous in Dicot stem vs. Sclerenchymatous in Monocot stem.
- **Ground Tissue & Pith:** Differentiated into cortex, endodermis, pericycle, medullary rays, and pith in Dicot stem vs. Undifferentiated ground tissue with no pith in Monocot stem.

3 MARKS 3. Stomatal Apparatus

- **Stomatal Aperture:** Central pore through which transpiration and gas exchange take place.
- **Guard Cells:** Bean/kidney-shaped in dicots and dumb-bell shaped in grasses; possess chloroplasts; regulate opening and closing of stoma.
- **Subsidiary Cells:** Specialized adjacent epidermal cells enclosing the guard cells that assist in their movement.

3 MARKS 4. Classification of Vascular Bundles

- **Radial:** Xylem and phloem lie on separate radii in an alternating manner (characteristic of roots).
- **Conjoint:** Xylem and phloem are arranged along the same radius (characteristic of stems and leaves).
- **Open vs. Closed:** Open has intrafascicular cambium present between xylem and phloem (capable of secondary growth, e.g., dicot stem); Closed lacks cambium (e.g., monocot stem).

3. HIGH-PRIORITY 2-MARK SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

2 MARKS Casparian Strips

A band of suberin (waxy, water-impermeable material) deposited on the radial and tangential walls of root endodermal cells. It regulates water and mineral movement into the stele.

2 MARKS Bulliform Cells

Large, empty, colourless modified epidermal cells along veins in grasses. When turgid, they expose the leaf surface; when flaccid (under water stress), leaves curl inwards to prevent water loss.

2 MARKS Exarch vs. Endarch Xylem

- **Exarch:** Protoxylem lies towards the periphery and metaxylem towards the centre (Roots).
- **Endarch:** Protoxylem lies towards the centre (pith) and metaxylem towards the periphery (Stems).

2 MARKS Trichomes vs. Root Hairs

- **Trichomes:** Multicellular epidermal hairs on stems; prevent transpirational water loss; may be branched/secretory.
- **Root Hairs:** Unicellular epiblemal elongations; absorb water and minerals from soil.

4. QUICK REVISION COMPARATIVE SUMMARY (TABLE)

Feature	Dicotyledonous Organ	Monocotyledonous Organ
Root Xylem Patches	2 to 4 patches (Diarch to Tetrarch)	More than 6 patches (Polyarch)
Root Pith	Small or inconspicuous	Large and well-developed
Stem Vascular Bundles	Arranged in a ring; Open (cambium present)	Scattered in ground tissue; Closed (cambium absent)
Stem Hypodermis	Collenchymatous	Sclerenchymatous
Stem Phloem Parenchyma	Present	Absent (water-containing cavities present)
Leaf Mesophyll	Differentiated (Palisade + Spongy parenchyma)	Undifferentiated
Guard Cells / Bulliform Cells	Bean-shaped guard cells; Bulliform cells absent	Dumb-bell guard cells (grasses); Bulliform cells present

5. HIGH-FREQUENCY 1-MARK TERMS & DEFINITIONS (VSA / MCQS)

- **Stele:** All tissues inner to the endodermis (Pericycle + Vascular Bundles + Pith).
- **Conjunctive Tissue:** Specialized parenchymatous cells present between xylem and phloem in roots.
- **Starch Sheath:** The innermost cortical layer (endodermis) of dicot stems, rich in starch grains.
- **Medullary Rays:** Radially arranged parenchymatous layers between vascular bundles in dicot stems.

6. MODEL BOARD EXAM QUESTIONS (TARGET: 4/4 MARKS)

1. Mention any three differences between Dicot Stem and Monocot Stem. **3M**
2. What are Casparian strips? Mention their location and significance. **2M**
3. Describe the structure of stomatal apparatus with a labeled sketch. **3M**
4. What are bulliform cells? State their function during water stress in grasses. **2M**
5. Distinguish between Radial and Conjoint vascular bundles. **2M**
6. Define stele. Name its constituents. **1M**
7. Which type of guard cells are found in grasses? **1M**